Consumer Behaviour Analysis

Consumer Preferences for AI Tools

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1. Project

The goal of this project is to analyse how consumers choose between the different AI assistants available today — ChatGPT (OpenAI), Gemini (Google), Copilot (Microsoft), Claude (Anthropic), and open-source alternatives. Over the past two years these tools have become part of everyday life for millions of people, both for work and personal use.

We want to understand what drives users to pick one tool over another. Is it the quality of the responses? The price? How easy it is to use? Or is it just habit? Our research focuses on identifying patterns in these preferences and checking whether they differ depending on the user profile — specifically, whether technically experienced users (developers, IT professionals) choose differently from general consumers (friends, family, classmates).

This topic connects directly with the tech industry we study in ASIX/DAM, and it gives us a chance to apply consumer behaviour analysis to a product we use ourselves every day.

2. Method

We used two different data collection instruments, each targeting a different demographic group. This dual approach allows us to compare consumer preferences between a technical, international audience and a local, general-public sample.

2.1 Instrument 1: Reddit Poll

Platform: Reddit — a social media platform organised into topic-based communities (subreddits) where users post and discuss content openly.

Subreddit chosen: r/ArtificialIntelligence — a general-purpose AI discussion community. We chose this subreddit because it has a broad audience of people interested in AI without being tied to any specific tool (unlike r/ChatGPT or r/Bard, which would introduce selection bias).

Post design process: We went through several decisions when designing the Reddit post. The first was the title — we deliberately chose "*Which AI assistant do you actually use daily? (Not which one you think is best)*" instead of something like "*What is the best AI tool?*" because we wanted to capture real daily usage habits,

not opinions based on benchmarks or hype. The distinction between "use" and "think is best" was key to getting honest answers.

Link to the original post: reddit.com/r/ArtificialInteligence — AI Assistant Poll

Poll options and why we chose them:

1. ChatGPT — the most well-known AI tool, used as a baseline
2. Gemini — Google's main competitor, integrated into Google Workspace
3. Claude — Anthropic's tool, gaining popularity among technical users
4. Copilot — Microsoft's option, built into Windows and Office
5. Open-source / local models — included because the subreddit has users who run their own AI models locally, and ignoring them would leave a gap in the data
6. I switch between several — we added this option after reading other discussion threads where many users said they don't stick to just one tool. Without this option, those users would have been forced to pick one, which would distort the results

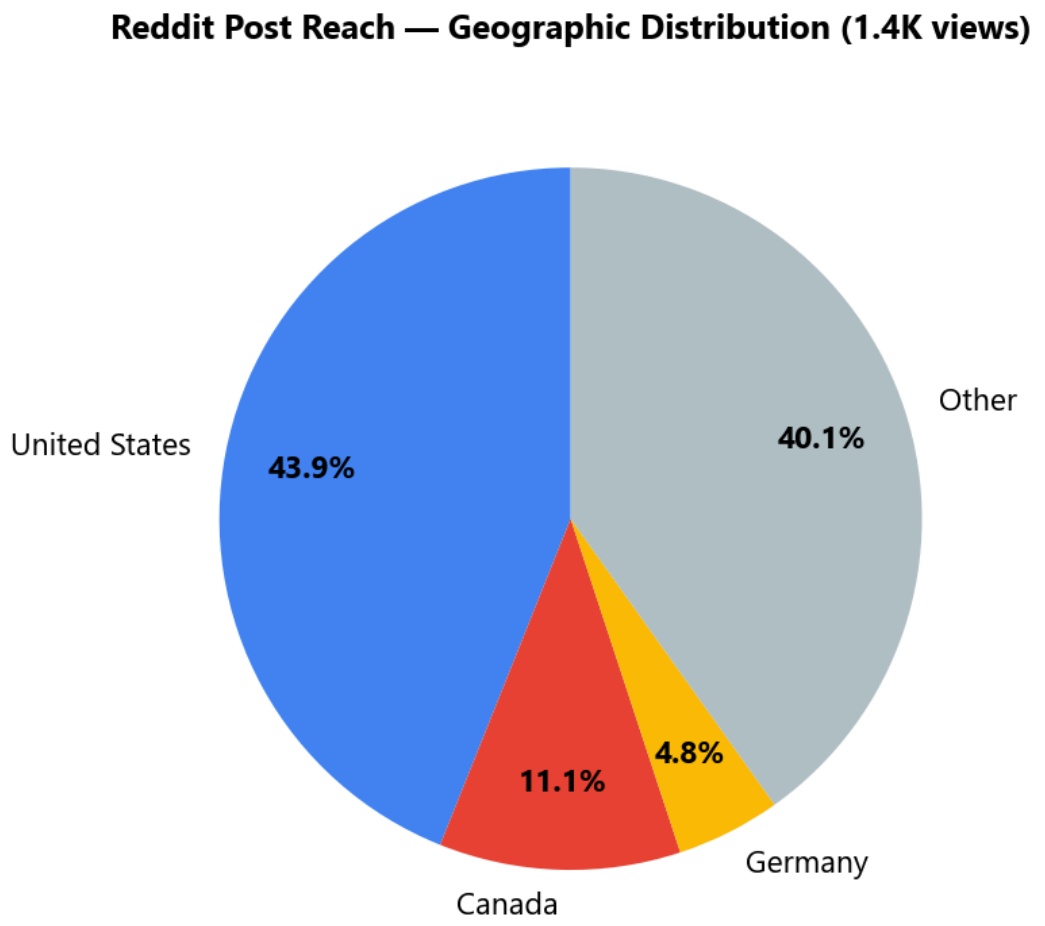
Discussion prompts included in the post body:

- What tool do you rely on, and what for?
- Are you paying or using the free version?
- Does the ecosystem matter? (e.g., using Copilot because of Windows/Office, or Gemini because of Google Workspace)

We placed these open-ended questions below the poll on purpose. The poll alone gives us numbers, but it does not tell us *why* people prefer a certain tool. The comments section is where users explain their reasoning — what features they value, what frustrations they have, and what made them switch. This combination of poll data (quantitative) and comment analysis (qualitative) makes the instrument more complete than either one alone.

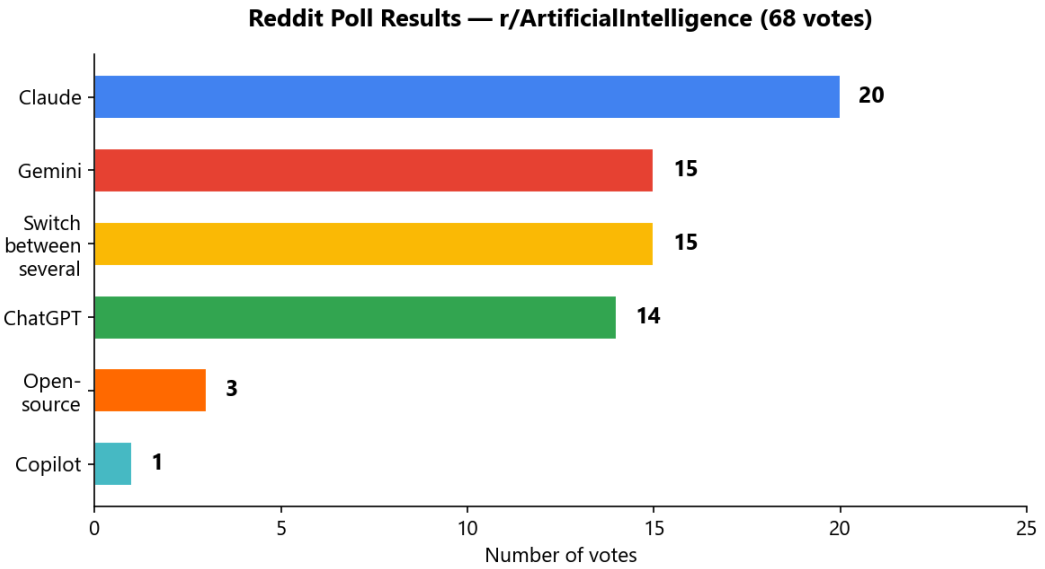
Reach and demographic data:

The post reached 1,400 views and collected 68 votes. The audience was predominantly international, with the following geographic distribution:



This confirms that the Reddit sample represents a technically experienced, internationally diverse audience — mostly from English-speaking countries and Europe.

Poll results collected (raw data):



2.2 Instrument 2: Google Forms Survey

Platform: Google Forms — an online survey tool that allows creating structured questionnaires with automatic response visualisation.

Target audience: Friends, family members, and classmates — people from our personal circle who represent a general consumer demographic. Most respondents are from Spain, aged between 18 and 50, and do not work in the tech industry.

Link to the survey: Google Forms — AI Tool Preferences Survey

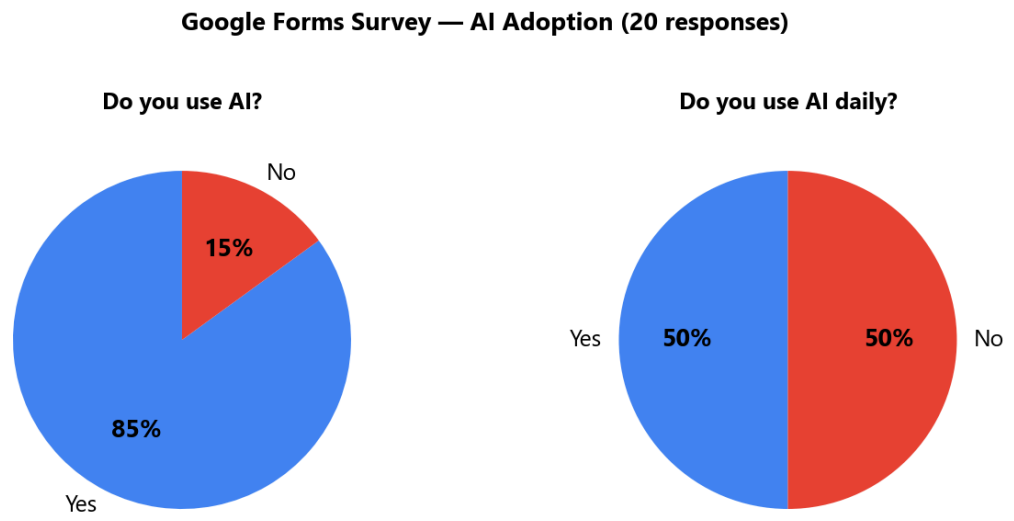
Survey design process: Since our target audience for this instrument was non-technical people (family, friends, classmates), we had to design the survey very differently from the Reddit post. We kept it to only 3 questions because a longer survey would have reduced the response rate — most of these people are not passionate about AI and would not spend more than 30 seconds on it.

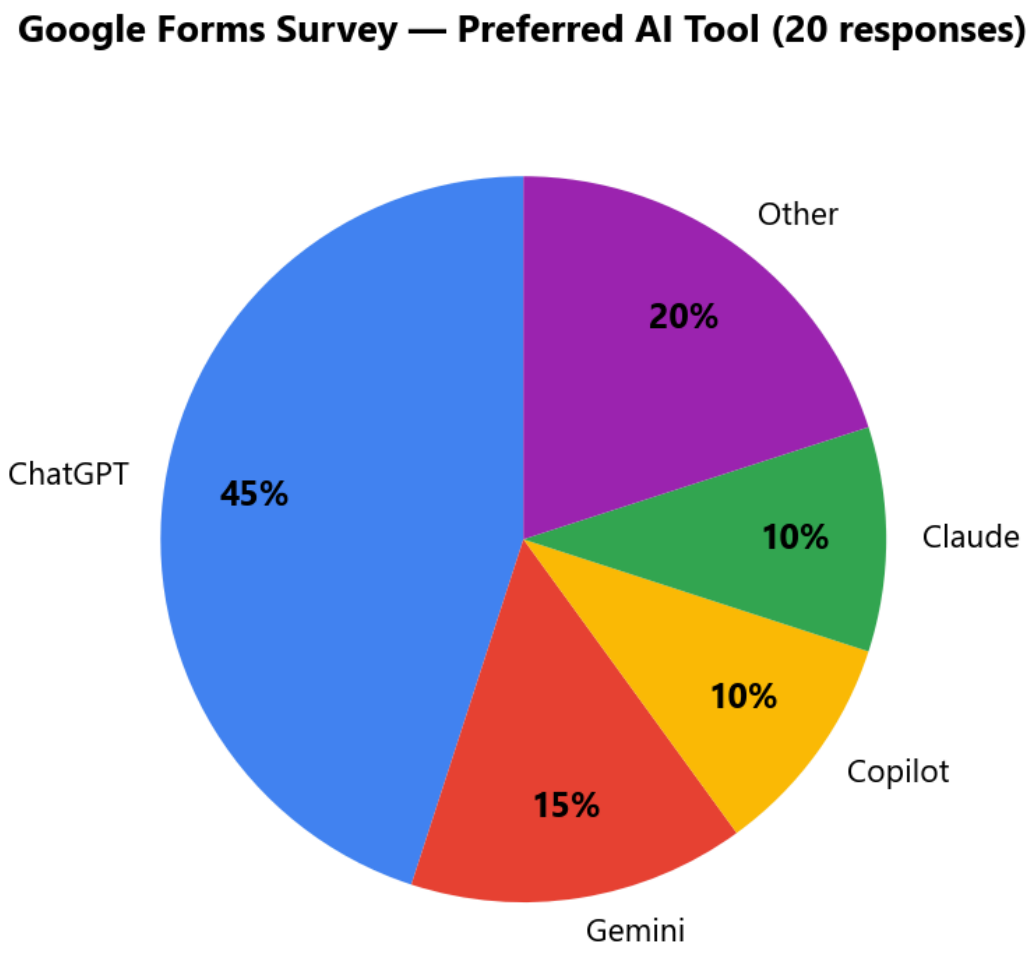
Survey questions and reasoning:

1. "*Do you use AI?*" — Yes / No — This first question acts as a filter. It tells us what percentage of general consumers have adopted AI at all, which is a data point we cannot get from Reddit (where everyone already uses AI).
2. "*Do you use AI daily?*" — Yes / No — This measures frequency of use. Someone who tried ChatGPT once is very different from someone who uses it every day, and we wanted to capture that difference.
3. "*If yes, which AI?*" — ChatGPT / Copilot / Gemini / Claude / Other — We offered the same major tools as the Reddit poll for consistency, but added "Other" as a catch-all since some respondents might use tools we did not list. We did not include "Open-source / local models" or "I switch between several" here because our general-public audience is unlikely to run local models or actively switch between multiple AI tools.

The survey was distributed through personal messaging (WhatsApp) and collected 20 responses. We recognise this is a small sample, but for a local, general-public demographic it is enough to identify basic trends and contrast them with the Reddit data.

Data collected (raw data):





Demographic value: This sample represents the general public — non-technical users who may use AI casually or not at all. The contrast with the Reddit audience is what makes the comparison possible.

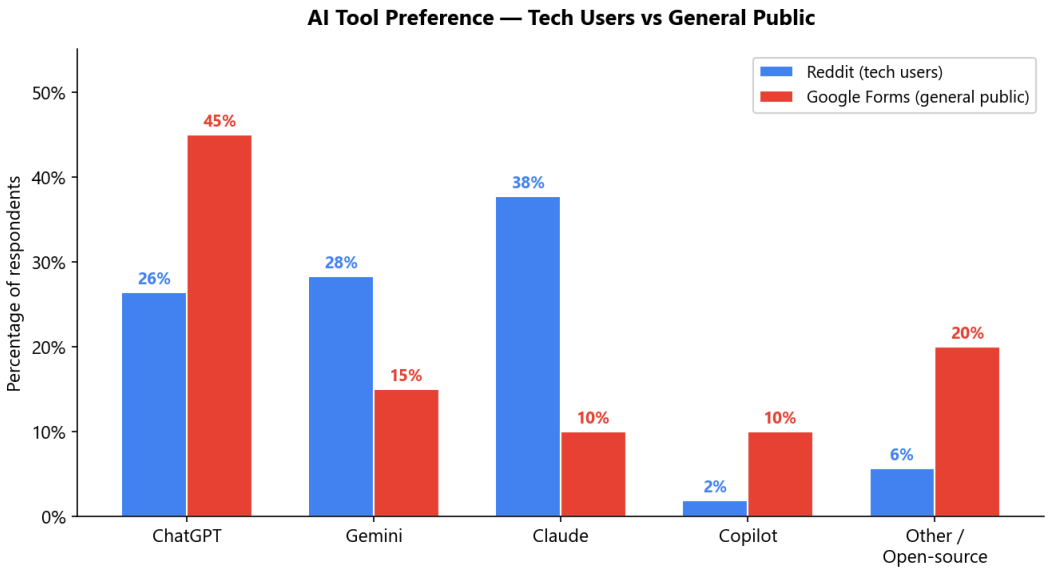
2.3 Why Two Instruments

Using two different instruments with two different audiences allows us to compare how consumer preferences shift between demographic groups. The Reddit poll captures the perspective of technically experienced, international users, while the Google Forms survey captures the preferences of everyday consumers in our local environment.

3. Analysis

3.1 Planned Comparison

The core of our analysis will be comparing the preferences from both data sources side by side. We have prepared the following comparison chart to visualise the demographic contrast:



For this comparison, we excluded the "I switch between several" responses from the Reddit poll and recalculated the percentages from the 53 single-tool votes, so both datasets are comparable.

3.2 Quantitative Questions We Plan to Answer

- Which AI tool is most popular overall, and does it depend on the audience?
- How large is the gap in AI adoption between tech users and general consumers?
- What percentage of general consumers use AI daily vs occasionally?
- Is there a tool that dominates one demographic but is barely present in the other?

3.3 Qualitative Analysis

The Reddit post also generated written comments where users explained their choices. We plan to analyse these comments to identify:

- What specific reasons do users give for choosing their preferred tool?
- Do users mention price, accuracy, speed, integrations, or privacy as decision factors?
- Are there users who switched tools recently? What triggered the switch?
- Does the ecosystem (Windows, Google, Apple) play a role in their decision?

We will group these recurring themes and present them as part of our presentation findings.

3.4 Demographic Comparison

The main analytical goal is to compare the two samples:

- **Tech-savvy international users (Reddit)** vs **general local consumers (Google Forms)**
- Which tools dominate in each group, and why might that be?
- Is there a significant gap in AI adoption between the two groups?
- Do non-technical users even know about alternatives beyond ChatGPT?

4. Benefit to Business

The insights from this type of consumer analysis could benefit AI companies and businesses that integrate AI tools in several ways:

Product positioning. If technical users prefer different tools than general consumers, companies need different marketing approaches for each segment. A tool that dominates among developers but is unknown to the general public has a clear growth opportunity — and the other way around.

Feature priorities. Understanding what factors drive preference (accuracy, price, ecosystem integration, privacy) helps companies decide where to invest their development resources.

Pricing models. Comparing free vs paid usage across demographics helps companies design pricing tiers that actually convert users. If a certain audience mostly uses free versions, the premium offering might need to be more compelling for that segment.

Adoption barriers. The survey data on AI adoption reveals how much of the general public still has not adopted these tools regularly. This represents a market opportunity for companies willing to simplify their products for non-technical users.

Retention and switching. If the data reveals that users frequently switch between tools, companies should focus on loyalty features — better integrations, personalised workflows, or ecosystem advantages that make users stay.

5. Bibliographic References

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